Nadia Brennan-Aziz

Senior Platform Engineer | Platform Engineering | Site Reliability Engineering

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Platform Engineer and platform team tech lead with experience building and operating AWS infrastructure and Kubernetes platforms. Strong hands-on experience with Terraform, EKS, infrastructure as code, service reliability, observability and capacity planning. Delivered an internal developer platform adopted by 14 product teams, reducing time from new service to production from approximately two weeks to under one day. Experienced in leading technical work across platform and product teams and communicating reliability goals with product leadership.

CORE SKILLS

Cloud and infrastructure: AWS, EKS, ECS, Terraform, Crossplane, infrastructure as code
Kubernetes and platform engineering: Kubernetes, Helm, Argo CD, Karpenter, golden-path service templates, Backstage catalog
Reliability and observability: SLOs, burn-rate alerting, Prometheus, Alertmanager, Grafana, Sloth, PagerDuty
Automation and development: Go, Python, GitHub Actions, controller-runtime
Performance and capacity: k6 load testing, capacity planning, AWS Spot

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Platform Engineer | Tallybrook Ltd *2022–Present*

Tech lead of the platform team, responsible for the EKS platform, internal developer platform, SLOs and infrastructure cost initiatives.

- Built an internal developer platform with Go and Python service templates, Argo CD ApplicationSets and Crossplane compositions for RDS, SQS and S3 resources requested through pull requests.
- Reduced the time to take a new service to production from approximately two weeks to under one day; the platform was adopted by all 14 product teams.
- Replaced cluster-autoscaler managed node groups with Karpenter and introduced Spot capacity for stateless workloads with interruption handling, reducing EC2 spend by 38% (approximately £410,000 per year).
- Established SLOs and burn-rate alerts for the 20 most critical services using Prometheus recording rules and Sloth; reduced pages per week by approximately 60% and agreed an error-budget policy with product leadership.
- Work with platform and product teams to develop and operate reliable, observable services and infrastructure.

Site Reliability Engineer | Brightwater Games *2019–2022*

- Built and operated AWS infrastructure using Terraform and supported game backend reliability through launches with more than one million daily players.
- Replaced Nagios alerting with Prometheus and Alertmanager.
- Led capacity planning for two major launches.
- Used k6 to simulate 300,000 concurrent players ahead of a 2020 launch, identifying and resolving a connection-pool limit before launch.
- Operated EKS in production from 2020.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Kubernetes Preview Namespace Cleanup Operator | Open-source side project *2024*

- Built a small Kubernetes controller in Go using controller-runtime to delete expired preview namespaces.
- Project has approximately 120 GitHub stars.

SPEAKING AND MENTORING

- Speaker, UK DevOps meetup (2024): “SLOs that product managers care about”.
- Mentored three engineers moving from backend engineering into SRE.

CERTIFICATION

- Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA)

TECHNOLOGY

AWS, EKS, ECS, Terraform, Crossplane, Kubernetes, Karpenter, Argo CD, Helm, GitHub Actions, Prometheus, Alertmanager, Grafana, Sloth, PagerDuty, k6, Go, Python, controller-runtime, Backstage (catalog).